Cristian Navarro

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Universitat Rovira i Virgili
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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor (Professor Lector) 2026 – present
Department of Economics, Universitat Rovira i Virgili

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics *(Cum Laude, International Doctorate Distinction)* 2022 – 2026
Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI)

Visiting Scholar Spring 2025
Uppsala University – Sponsor: Luca Repetto

M.Sc. in Economics and Finance 2020 – 2022
Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI)

M.Sc. in Economics 2018 – 2020
Universitat de Barcelona
Erasmus+ Exchange – University of Copenhagen (Fall 2019)

B.A. in Economics 2012 – 2016
Universitat de Barcelona

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Political Economy, Economic History
Secondary: Development Economics

PUBLICATIONS

"Personalized Employment Support for the Homeless: Evidence from a Randomized Evaluation" (with Miguel Almunia and Begoña Varela Merino) - *SERIEs – Journal of the Spanish Economic Association (accepted).*

WORKING PAPERS

"Autocrats Remake the State: Evidence from Francoist Spain", with Ricard Grebol – *Job Market Paper*

In autocracies, personnel decisions often prioritize ideological alignment over merit. We investigate how such ideology-based personnel selection shapes the quality of the public workforce and its implications for state capacity. We examine this in the context of a large-scale political purge and reorganization of primary school teachers carried out by the Francoist dictatorship following the Spanish Civil War (1936-1939). We construct a novel dataset linking newly digitized purge archives and administrative records that track teacher careers, and document that more competent teachers were disproportionately dismissed and that average experience declined by about 2.6 years (14.4%). Local shortages created by the purge were partly offset by regime efforts to reassign teachers across municipalities, yet coordination frictions in this process left persistent staffing deficits that spread to areas less affected by the purge. Our findings show how ideology-based personnel reforms can erode public workforce expertise and weaken the state's capacity to deliver essential services, providing a mechanism through which autocratic consolidation entails sizable capacity costs.

"Seeds of Prejudice: The impact of British colonization on attitudes towards sexual minorities", with Alexsandros Cavgias – *Submitted*

CEMFI Working Paper Series 2514 – IDEAS/RePEc WP 25/1117

This paper provides the first causal test of the hypothesis that British colonial institutions promoted sexual prejudice in postcolonial societies. OLS estimates across former European colonies show higher sexual prejudice in former British colonies than in those of other European powers, conditional on contemporary economic development. Geo-RDD estimates similarly show significantly higher sexual prejudice in former British than Portuguese colonies in Southern and Eastern Africa, where local norms did not systematically condemn same-sex relations. Evidence from South America and Southeast Asia reveals the same pattern. By contrast, British and French colonies display similar levels of sexual prejudice in Western Africa, where non-colonial religious norms condemning same-sex acts are more prevalent. Mechanisms analysis suggests that exposure to alien social norms through colonial legislation is the key mechanism linking British colonial institutions to contemporary sexual prejudice. Overall, our results indicate that British colonialism increased sexual prejudice where social norms differed from colonizers' penal codes.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Ballot measures, political advertising, and contribution caps", with Pello Aspuru

"Why Inform? Ideology, Interest, and Animosity in Times of the Inquisition", with Álvaro Sánchez-Leache

"The Political and Economic Costs of Armed Nationalism: Evidence from ETA and the Basque Country", with Ricard Grebol and Luca Repetto

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND SEMINAR (S)

Universitat Rovira i Virgili (S), Universidad Pablo de Olavide (S), ICADE (S), 4th Workshop in Economic History (Uppsala), 1st Spanish Political Economy International Network (SPEIN) Workshop, 51 Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía (scheduled)	2026
Uppsala University (S), 3rd Workshop in Economic History (Uppsala), 3rd Spanish Workshop in Development Economics, Madrid Empirical Social Sciences Conference	2025
SITES-GLO Annual Conference, 2nd Spanish Workshop in Development Economics, 49 Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía	2024

PRE-PhD PUBLICATIONS

"Globalisation and natural resource abundance. Is export diversification possible? A comparison of export composition in Chile and Norway, 1870-2017", with Marc Badia-Miró, José Peres-Cajías and Anna Carreras Marin. *Natural Resources and Divergence: A Comparison of Andean and Nordic Trajectories,* 2021. Palgrave Macmillan. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-030-71044-6_2

PREVIOUS RESEARCH AND WORKING EXPERIENCE

CEMFI, Visiting Researcher	June – July 2026
CEMFI, Research Assistant for Professor Monica Martinez-Bravo (part-time)	2022 – 2023
Univ. de Barcelona, Research Assistant for Professor Marc Badia-Miró (part-time)	2018 – 2019
Sant Cugat del Vallès City Council – Project officer	Apr 2018 – Sep 2018
PricewaterhouseCoopers – Business Consultant	Aug 2016 – Apr 2018

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Uncertainty and Information (Microeconomics II) — Winter 2024, Winter 2025
CEMFI – TA for Professor Guillermo Caruana

Markets and Organizations — Spring 2023
CEMFI – TA for Professor Guillermo Caruana and Wouter Vergote

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

CEMFI doctoral fellowship, María de Maeztu Unit of Excellence (MDM-2016-0684)	2022 – 2026
Predoctoral Fellowship for Doctoral Training (PRE2022-102202), Ministry of Science, Innovation and Universities	2023 – 2026
Maria de Maeztu Exploration grant (€7,500)	2024
María de Maeztu Scholarship (M.Sc., MDM-2016-0684)	2020 – 2022
Extraordinary award for the MSc (Universitat de Barcelona)	2020
Fundació Catalunya La Pedrera Scholarship	2018 – 2020
Extraordinary award for the B.A. (Universitat de Barcelona)	2016

REFERENCES

Carlos Sanz	**Samuel Bentolila**	**Tom Zohar**	**Luca Repetto**
Bank of Spain and CEMFI	CEMFI	CEMFI	Uppsala University
carlossanz@bde.es	bentolila@cemfi.es	tom.zohar@cemfi.es	luca.repetto@nek.uu.se

OTHER INFORMATION

Languages: English (fluent), Catalan and Spanish (native)

Programming: Stata, R, QGIS, Python, LaTeX

Citizenship: Spanish